

Who wants to become a billionaire?

Most of us dream of **striking it rich**; to never be **in want**. Good goals.

To achieve these, would **entail considerable diligence** and **perseverance**, **resourcefulness** and creativity. A rare few are **endowed with inherited** wealth, but for most, the process is a challenge that includes many struggles.

To understand what it is that we're after, we need to first know what it means to be wealthy, to be rich. But wait a second, wealth and riches are not really synonymous, **points out** Swami Swaroopananda, global head, Chinmaya Mission. He reminds us that the universe is a resource, it is wealth. Hence nature is called Sri. Lakshmi, bringing **prosperity** and wealth. Whatever you produce, comes from nature. He adds that **those** who make the effort to make use of these resources productively, **find** wealth.

We benefit from the earth because the earth is a giver; for **millennia** the earth's resources have been used to create wealth. And for as long as we can remember, we have been **takers**. "Except for human beings, all other species give back to earth. That's why the world is rich. Adi Shankara was asked who was poor and he replied that the one who has **insatiable**, infinite desires and who feels he does not have enough, that he is not rich enough – he is truly poor."

If you have food, shelter and clothing and you sleep well, you are not poor. Having a **fat** bank balance does not guarantee happiness – many among the richest are often unable to eat or sleep due to compromised health and stress, infinite desires and sense of dissatisfaction. An unhappy mind means your body too slowly becomes unhappy and therefore unhealthy. Diseases may **creep in**. Stress and anger are known to be major causes of high blood pressure.

Iago in Shakespeare's Othello says: "Poor and **content** is rich, and rich enough, But riches fineless is as poor as winter To him that ever fears he shall be poor, Good heaven, the souls of all my tribe defend From jealousy!" Why be jealous of a super wealthy man who lives in constant fear of becoming poor and who is **beleaguered** by ill-health?

Several **references** in scriptures, proverbs and stories **hold** a brief for **contentment** – that you are truly rich only when you do not **hanker** for more; when you are content with what you have, whether you have less or more than a monetarily wealthy person.

When you share **spontaneously**, even if you are not so wealthy, even if you are poor. "Not he who has much is rich, but he who gives much," says the Bible. We are poor when we hoard and we **cling** to what we have **accumulated** whereas the more we give, the more **enriched** are we.

"You may lose money, but try not to lose your mind," says Swamiji. "And never lose your faith in a higher power, in nature, in knowledge. Faith comes from **gratitude**." When you are enriched by

positive attitude, good mind and a spirit of sharing, and you enjoy good health since mind and body are closely connected, richness stays with you whereas wealth may come and go.

Your capacity to smile, makes you rich. You can feel the **abundance**. In short, you are richer than a **so-called** wealthy billionaire.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

@mocks_wallah

Vocabulary

1. **Strike it rich** (phrase) – Become wealthy, Get rich, Hit the jackpot, Make a fortune, Achieve success अमीर बनना
2. **In want** (phrase) – Needy, Poor, Destitute, Deprived, Impoverished गरीब
3. **Entail** (verb) – Involve, Require, Necessitate, Demand, Include आवश्यक बनाना
4. **Considerable** (adjective) – Significant, Substantial, Large, Extensive, Ample काफी
5. **Diligence** (noun) – Hard work, Persistence, Effort, Carefulness, Industriousness मेहनत
6. **Perseverance** (noun) – Persistence, Determination, Tenacity, Endurance, Resolve दृढ़ता
7. **Resourcefulness** (noun) – Ingenuity, Creativity, Inventiveness, Adaptability, Cleverness साधनसंपन्नता
8. **Endow** (with) (verb) – Provide, Gift, Bestow, Equip, Furnish प्रदान करना
9. **Inherited** (adjective) – Hereditary, Genetic, Ancestral, Family, Passed down विरासत में मिला
10. **Point out** (phrasal verb) – Highlight, Indicate, Mention, Emphasize, Note इंगित करना
11. **Prosperity** (noun) – Wealth, Success, Affluence, Fortune, Well-being समृद्धि
12. **Millennia** (noun) – Thousands of years, Ages, Eons, Centuries, Long period सहस्राब्दी
13. **Taker** (noun) – Receiver, Acceptor, Beneficiary, Recipient, Consumer लेने वाला
14. **Insatiable** (adjective) – Unquenchable, Greedy, Voracious, Ravenous, Unappeasable अतृप्त
15. **Fat** (adjective) – Large, Substantial, Plentiful, Abundant, Considerable मोटा
16. **Creep in** (phrasal verb) – Sneak in, Slip in, Enter gradually, Infiltrate, Intrude धीरे-धीरे आना
17. **Content** (adjective) – Satisfied, Happy, Pleased, Fulfilled, Comfortable संतुष्ट
18. **Beleaguered** (adjective) – Troubled, Harassed, Besieged, Stressed, Overwhelmed परेशान
19. **Contentment** (noun) – Satisfaction, Happiness, Fulfillment, Peace, Ease संतोष
20. **Hanker** (verb) – Crave, Desire, Long, Yearn, Covet लालसा करना
21. **Spontaneously** (adverb) – Naturally, Instinctively, Impulsively, Freely, Unplanned स्वतःस्फूर्त

22. **Cling** (to) (verb) – Hold, Grasp, Clutch,
Adhere, Stick चिपकना

23. **Accumulate** (verb) – Gather, Collect,
Amass, Hoard, Build up जमा करना

24. **Enrich** (verb) – Enhance, Improve,
Augment, Fortify, Uplift समृद्ध करना

25. **Gratitude** (noun) – Thankfulness,
Appreciation, Gratefulness, Recognition,
Acknowledgment कृतज्ञता

26. **Abundance** (noun) – Plenty, Wealth,
Profusion, Copiousness, Ample प्रचुरता

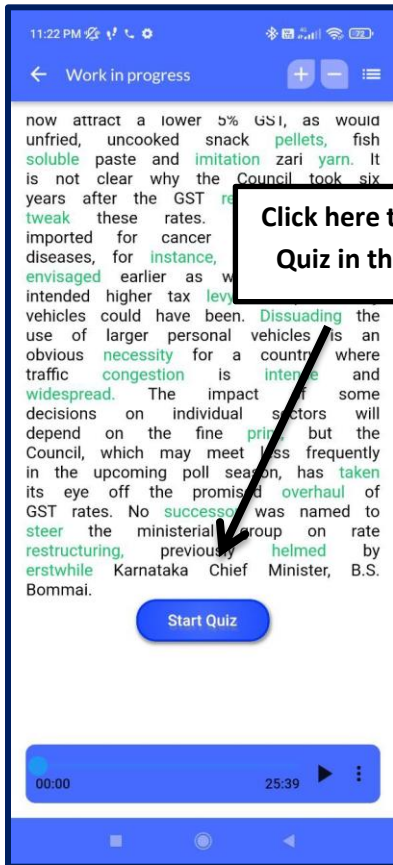
27. **So-called** (adjective) – Alleged, Supposed,
Ostensible, Purported, Nominal तथाकथित

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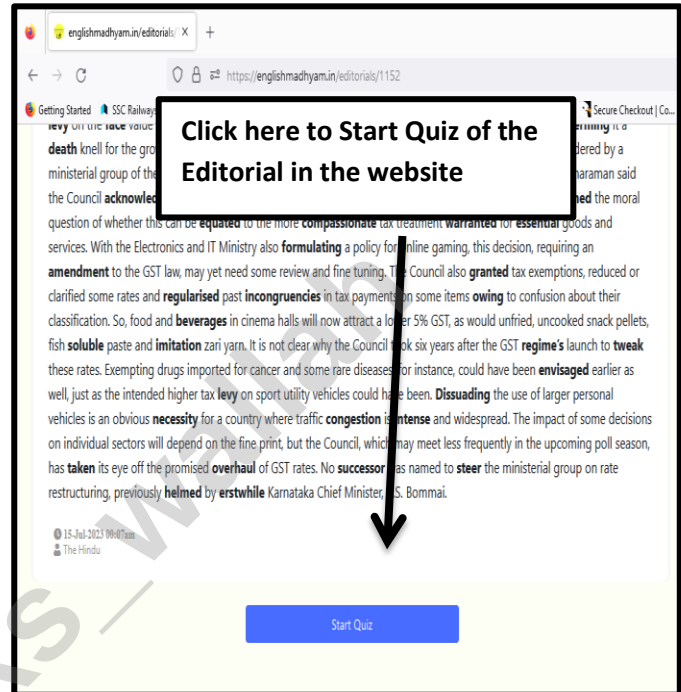
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Dreams of Wealth:** Many dream of becoming wealthy to achieve financial freedom and security.
2. **Path to Wealth:** Achieving wealth requires diligence, perseverance, resourcefulness, and creativity, with only a few benefiting from inherited riches.
3. **Wealth vs. Riches:** Wealth and riches are not synonymous; wealth is derived from nature's resources, while riches are often material.
4. **Nature as Wealth:** The universe, or nature, is the ultimate source of wealth, providing resources for prosperity.
5. **Productive Use of Resources:** Those who utilize nature's resources productively create wealth.
6. **Earth as a Giver:** The earth has provided resources for millennia, but humans have largely been takers, unlike other species that give back.
7. **True Poverty:** Adi Shankara defined poverty as having insatiable desires and a perpetual sense of lack, regardless of material wealth.
8. **Basic Needs:** Having food, shelter, clothing, and peace of mind means one is not poor, regardless of bank balance.
9. **Wealth and Happiness:** A large bank balance does not guarantee happiness; many wealthy individuals suffer from stress, poor health, and dissatisfaction.
10. **Health and Contentment:** An unhappy mind leads to an unhealthy body, with stress and anger contributing to diseases like high blood pressure.
11. **Shakespeare's Insight:** Iago in *Othello* highlights that contentment makes one rich, while endless riches without peace equate to poverty.
12. **Contentment in Scriptures:** Scriptures and proverbs emphasize that true richness lies in contentment, not in accumulating wealth.
13. **Sharing Enriches:** Sharing, even when one is not wealthy, brings true enrichment, as giving fosters abundance.
14. **Faith and Gratitude:** Maintaining faith in a higher power, nature, and knowledge, along with gratitude, enriches life more than material wealth.
15. **Inner Richness:** A positive attitude, a good mind, and a spirit of sharing make one truly rich, regardless of financial status.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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